PicoCTF 2026
SUDO MAKE ME A SANDWICH

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Easy | General Skills | picoCTF 2026

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Description

Can you read the flag? I think you can!

In this challenge, we're asked to read the flag somehow...

SUDO MAKE ME A SANDWICH
Sudo Enumeration

```
ctf-player@challenge:~$ ls
flag.txt
ctf-player@challenge:~$ cat flag.txt
cat: flag.txt: Permission denied
```

When we arrive in the server, we check our current directory we see that the flag file is here, but we can't read it, since we don't have read permissions on the file

SUDO MAKE ME A SANDWICH
Sudo Enumeration

```
ctf-player@challenge:~$ sudo -l
Matching Defaults entries for ctf-player on challenge:
    env_reset, mail_badpass,
    secure_path=/usr/local/sbin\:/usr/local/bin\:/usr/sbin\:

User ctf-player may run the following commands on challenge:
    (ALL) NOPASSWD: /bin/emacs
```

But if we check our sudo permissions with the sudo -l command, and we see we can run sudo with the emacs command

SUDO MAKE ME A SANDWICH
Sudo Command

```
└─$ cat root.txt
cat: root.txt: Permission denied

┌──(theshyhat㉿hackerfrogs)-[/tmp]
└─$ sudo cat root.txt
[sudo] password for theshyhat:
You can read the file! You must be root!
```

In Linux, the sudo command is used to run a command in the context of another user, usually the root user (the super user)

SUDO MAKE ME A SANDWICH
Sudo Command

```
ctf-player@challenge:~$ sudo -l
Matching Defaults entries for ctf-player on challenge:
    env_reset, mail_badpass,
    secure_path=/usr/local/sbin\:/usr/local/bin\:/usr/sbin\:/

User ctf-player may run the following commands on challenge:
    (ALL) NOPASSWD: /bin/emacs
```

So sudo lets you run commands as the root user for one command at a time, and in this case we can run it with the emacs text editor

SUDO MAKE ME A SANDWICH
Sudo Command

```
File Edit Options Buffers Tools
picoCTF{[redacted]}
```

Emacs is a text editor program, so we can read the flag.txt file that is owned by root if we run it with sudo